

Wiki goes dark

Wikipedia shut down its Russian site for a day to protect online freedom, as a protest against a legislation under consideration in Moscow. <http://dgit.in/NpheSa>



World Wonders Project

Based on Street View, it's a feature of Google Maps that allows you to navigate on street-level. <http://dgit.in/NMCTof>

Facebook round-up

The world's largest social network had changed users' default email addresses to @facebook.com, for a short while in the end of June, without notifying users, drawing severe criticism.

Facebook had launched an email service in November 2010 amidst very little fanfare.

Programming Interface (API), which pulled the last e-mail address mentioned in the account, instead of the primary e-mail addresses.

Referring to reports on 'lost' e-mails due to change in contact info, the social networking company said that by default, messages from friends or friends' friends

in these countries will see the App Center bookmark on the left navigation menu on Facebook and also on iOS and Android apps. The social networking company will be rolling out App Center to users in Brazil, France, Germany, Russia, Spain, Taiwan, and Turkey in the coming weeks. To put in Zuckerberg's words, there will be a more frictionless experience on Facebook.

Facebook is also rumoured to launch a job posting service, one that would compete with the professional social media site LinkedIn. According to reports,

Facebook has already partnered with various job-posting companies such as BranchOut, Jobvite and Work4Labs, which are expected to pair with the platform. Facebook refused to comment on rumours of launching a job board.

July also saw Facebook redesign its Events feature, adding Calender and List views. It allows users to view friends' upcoming birthdays, event invites and even suggested events on a calender – instead of the traditional list format. It is funny how even Google+ announced an Events feature. 



Facebook App center

The social networking company allowed users to have @facebook.com addresses and receive normal e-mails in their message inboxes. The service, then foreseen as an attempt to take on Gmail, was aimed at enabling users to communicate with external email addresses via Facebook.

The social networking giant said change was due to a bug within the Application

come into users' inbox. And everything else moves to *Other* folder, which is placed below *Messages* in your left hand navigation menu.

In the meanwhile, Facebook began a global roll-out of App Center, its web and mobile Facebook app repository. It is now available in seven more countries, including Canada, Ireland, New Zealand, South Africa, U.K. and India. Users

Digg sold for \$500,000

Digg, a once-popular social bookmarking site, has been acquired by BetaWorks, for a paltry sum of \$500,000. The site has been slipping in popularity for a while, losing users to competition from Reddit, and Pinterest. Back in 2006, Digg was amongst the top 25 web sites visited in the U.S.

According to ZDnet, Digg's fate started turning around in 2010, when a group, the Digg Patriots, was revealed to be attempting to censor certain liberal campaigns, using multiple accounts to ban certain posts.

Kevin Rose, Digg's co-founder, then apparently tried to rework the Digg voting system to remove the perceived potential for partiality. Unfortunately however, the Digg community felt the voting system was no longer in their hands to control, and left in droves.

By 2012, Digg barely had any staff left to run it. According to a Wall Street Journal report on the matter, after the acquisition, no Digg employees will be retained. Digg will apparently be integrated into BetaWorks' news.me service, which will send news and other posts to users via mobile and email, from Facebook, Twitter and Digg feeds.

Speaking about the acquisition, Matt Williams, Digg's CEO, said, "Digg has always been a site built by the community, for the community. Over the last few months, we've considered many options of where Digg could go, and frankly many of them could not live up to the reason Digg was invented in the first place – to discover the best stuff on the web. We wanted to find a way to take Digg back to its startup roots." 

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